

Brendon Hawkins

I n t e l l i g e n c e L e a d e r & I n n o v a t o r

Melbourne, Australia

 brendon@brendonhawkins.com
 brendonhawkins.com
 brendonhawkins.substack.com
 [brendon-hawkins-6648931b2](https://www.linkedin.com/in/brendon-hawkins-6648931b2)
 +61 403 135 535

Summary

Senior intelligence leader with over 20 years' experience across national security and corporate domains, with a proven record of innovation at the intersection of tradecraft and emerging technology. I have designed and led capabilities across signals, cyber, criminal, geospatial, and insider threat domains, while building custom analytic tools, AI prototypes, and novel analytic techniques that have reshaped how organisations detect and respond to threats.

My career has consistently combined high-stakes leadership with technical creativity. I have held leadership and specialist positions in the Australian Intelligence Community, the Royal Australian Air Force, state policing, and corporate roles at National Broadband Network and ANZ. Across these environments I've managed high-performing teams, designed process and tradecraft, trained hundreds of analysts, and delivered actionable intelligence to senior decision makers under pressure.

At this stage, I am focused on pushing intelligence beyond its traditional boundaries. My next chapter is a portfolio career combining operational excellence with systemic innovation. This includes applying AI to intelligence processes by building custom tools to augment human analysts and developing new frameworks for values-aligned analysis and systemic adaptation. Ultimately, I want to harness the powerful capabilities of intelligence to illuminate uncertainty wherever it arises, applying its methods not only to security, but to the broader challenges of governance, technology, risk, and broader society.

Skills

Leadership: Full-cycle intelligence management; interagency liaison; training management; strategic advisor to senior leadership; strategic forecasting.

Intelligence Disciplines: Signals intelligence; communications metadata analysis; criminal intelligence; geospatial intelligence analysis; insider threat; cyber threat intelligence; geopolitical intelligence; access development; collection management; deployed operational and tactical intelligence; strategic analytic techniques; analytic technique development.

Programming: Python, specialising in: data analysis packages; geospatial analysis; natural language processing; process automation; imagery processing; custom intelligence tools; custom collection platforms; AI tools through programmatic interfaces. SQL, particularly PostgreSQL.

Intelligence tools: i2 Analyst Notebook; iBase; Palantir; Constellation.

Geospatial analysis: ArcGIS; QGIS; PostGIS; Geopandas; proprietary imagery analysis tools; custom geospatial tools.

Other tools: Dtex; Splunk; Tableau; SAS; Alteryx; Postgres.

Employment History

IndependINT (July 2018 – Present)

- Independent R&D in intelligence, values, AI, and governance (July 2025 – present)
 - Developing intelligence training courses.
 - Developing prototype intelligence tools through IndependINT.
 - Publishing essays on systems alignment and values intelligence.
 - Building portfolio of innovation-oriented projects.

ANZ (Australia and New Zealand Banking Group)

- Product Owner, Cyber Threat Intelligence (June 2023 – July 2025)
 - Head of the cyber threat intelligence capability at one of Australia's largest companies.
 - Daily operational leadership of cyber threat intelligence team with highly technical specialist skills, as well as leadership input into other technical cyber security capabilities.
 - System design, process uplift, and analyst upskilling of a mature, industry-leading, but continually innovating cyber threat intelligence capability.
 - Leader of cyber threat intelligence activities including threat mapping, threat hunt, detection engineering, campaign analysis, and situational awareness.
 - Responsible for government and industry liaison on intelligence matters.
 - Managing stakeholder relationships, intelligence priorities, and response to feedback.
 - Senior intelligence tradecraft specialist at ANZ, with regular training delivered to intelligence and wider cyber domain staff.

National Broadband Network

- Manager, Security Intelligence Centre, nbn (July 2021 – June 2023):
 - Corporate manager for security intelligence across nbn's converged security model, responsible for: insider threat, cyber threat intelligence, geopolitical intelligence, counter foreign interference intelligence, security behavioural analytics, and intelligence support to: physical security, personnel security, internal security assurance, third-party assurance, and investigations.
 - Daily operational management of a team of intelligence professionals made up of former Australian Intelligence Community members, data scientists, computer scientists, and security specialists.
 - Responsible for government and industry liaison on intelligence matters.
 - Managing stakeholder relationships, intelligence priorities, and response to feedback.
 - Leading major uplift of intelligence processes across converged security accountabilities.
 - Senior advisor to nbn Chief Security Officer for cyber and geopolitical threats.
- Intelligence Operations Lead, Security Intelligence Centre, nbn (January 2020 – July 2021):
 - Team lead for intelligence production.
 - Led security behavioural analytics for insider threat assessments.
 - Led threat hunt and attribution assessment activities for cyber incidents.
 - Produced, edited, and disseminated intelligence reporting.
 - Led intelligence training activities for nbn's security analysts.
 - Developed and deployed intelligence collection and processing tools.
- Intelligence Analyst, Security Intelligence Centre, nbn (December 2017 – January 2020):

WA Police

- Intelligence analyst, Great Southern District (September 2015 – December 2017):
 - Led intelligence prioritisation, planning, collection and production for the Great Southern District.
 - Produced intelligence reporting in support of regional policing priorities and investigations.
 - Provided technical advice on intelligence matters to senior officers in the police district.
 - Produced statistical reporting on crime trends, using SAS visual analysis software.
 - Conceived, designed and developed a telecommunications metadata database for WA Police.

Coles South Bunbury

- Nightfill manager (September 2014 – September 2015):
 - Managed a large team of 25 staff to complete nightly grocery fill. Undertaken while a full-time student at Edith Cowan University Bunbury.

Australian Geospatial-Intelligence Organisation (AGO)

- Operations manager, Hard and Irregular Targets (APS EL1, March 2013 – April 2014):
 - Led teams of intelligence analysts from multiple agencies in geospatial intelligence surge operations against the most challenging intelligence targets facing the Department of Defence.
 - Planned and resourced geospatial intelligence operations.
 - Led interagency liaison for geospatial intelligence operations.
 - Produced post operational reports for geospatial intelligence operations.
 - Performed advanced geospatial intelligence analysis including analytic technique development.
 - Successfully conceived, designed and led the creation of a new bulk geospatial analysis tool which was subsequently built by a team of software developers.
 - Developed and delivered training.
 - Performed corporate activities in line with assistant director position including interagency liaison, policy development, and legal compliance.
 - AGO representative for user group for Australian Intelligence Community software modernisation project.
- Long service leave (September 2012 – March 2013):
 - Travelled through North and South America.
- Team lead and senior intelligence analyst, Directorate of National Security Support (APS L6, September 2011 – September 2012):
 - Led intelligence production for AGO's cyber security team.
 - Performed advanced geospatial intelligence analysis including analytic technique development.
 - Led vision shaping and liaison with defence contractors during early phases of major software acquisition project DEF2044.
 - Supported senior executive negotiations over data sharing, target deconfliction and cooperation in a major self-initiated project.

Australian Signals Directorate (ASD)

- Deployed senior intelligence analyst, Operation SLIPPER (APS L6, January 2011 – July 2011):
 - Conducted intelligence analysis against a range of targets in Afghanistan.
 - Provided intelligence support to deployed elements as part of Combined Team Uruzgan.
 - Supported policing elements in insurgent targeting and prosecution.
 - Led technical liaison for communications intelligence with allied forces deployed to Uruzgan.
- Senior intelligence analyst, Support to Military Operations (SMO) Branch (APS L6, July 2010 – January 2011):
 - Conducted intelligence analysis against a range of targets.
 - Provided intelligence support to deployed forces.
 - Developed advanced analytic technique.
 - Conducted pre-deployment training.
- Training manager, ASD Academy (APS L6, November 2008 – July 2010, July 2011-September 2011):
 - Managed training for a major intelligence stream of approximately 200 analysts.

- Developed and delivered training to hundreds of intelligence analysts.
- Led international liaison for training in a major technical intelligence stream.
- Led a senior executive-initiated corporate project as part of analytic modernisation program.

Royal Australian Air Force

- Intelligence analyst and team lead, SMO Branch, ASD (Corporal, April 2007 – November 2008):
- Electronic warfare operator, Operation ASTUTE, East Timor (Leading Aircraftman, August 2006 – January 2007) (post-deployment leave until April 2007):
- Electronic Warfare Operator, Joint Electronic Warfare Operational Support Unit (Leading Aircraftman, January 2005 – August 2006):
- Language student (Indonesian), ADF School of Languages (Aircraftman, July 2004 – December 2004).
- Electronic Warfare Operator, ASD (Aircraftman, March 2003 – July 2004).
- Initial employment training, Joint Telecommunications School (Aircraftman, January 2002 – March 2003).

Education and training

Tertiary

2020 – 2021	Graduate Certificate of Intelligence Analysis, Charles Sturt University.
2010 – 2015	Bachelor of Arts (part time, incomplete).
2008	Certificate IV - Training and Education.
2004	Diploma of Indonesian, ADF School of Languages.

Australian Intelligence Community

2012 – 2014	Australian Public Service management training (various courses).
2011 – 2014	Advanced classified geospatial and imagery intelligence training.
2007 – 2011	Advanced classified signals intelligence training: • Analytic technique, tool training. • Includes training by NSA and GCHQ. • Course length between 1 day and three weeks.
2012	Intelligence report editing. Intelligence operations manager training.
2010	Pre-deployment training – Operation Slipper (Afghanistan). Geospatial metadata analysis (ArcGIS).
2009	Structured strategic analytic techniques. Analysis of competing hypotheses. Covert internet research training. Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT).
2008	Denial and Deception.
2007	Introduction to signals intelligence. Intelligence report writing. Communications theory. Presentation Skills. Introduction to the Australian Intelligence Community.

Military

2007	Corporal promotion course.
2006	Indonesian language continuation training, Bandung, Indonesia. Pre-deployment training – 4 weeks, Queensland (2006). • Including intelligence collection systems. • For deployment to East Timor 2006/2007.
2005	Technical collection system training (RAAF).
2003	Signals Operator Linguist initial employment training. Technical strategic collection system training (ASD).
2002	RAAF recruit training.

Commercial Software Training

2024	Recorded Future Advanced Analyst Training.
2020	Splunk Intermediate.
2017	Analyst Notebook Intermediate.
2016	SAS Visual Analysis.
2011	Palantir.

Teaching (ASD Canberra, 2008-2011):

- Critical thinking - 1 day – managed, developed and delivered.
- Introduction to Signals Intelligence – 5 days – managed, developed and delivered.
- Communications metadata analysis – 5 days – managed, developed and delivered.
- Intermediate computer to computer communications analysis – 3 weeks – managed, with some development and delivery.
- Signals Intelligence Exercise – 2 days – managed, developed and delivered.
- Various classified specialist communications intelligence courses, basic to advanced – managed, developed and delivered.

Referees

Simon Lee-Steere

Chief Security Officer at Visy

Relationship: Direct Manager, June 2021-June 2023 (NBN)

Min Livanidis

Chief Security Advisor at Microsoft

Relationship: Direct Manager, December 2017-June 2021 (NBN)

Contact details are available on request.